

The End-to-End Law Firm System: Setup, Inbound Calls, Case Management & Client Portal

A Step-by-Step Practical Guide Explaining How to Create the Firm, Route Calls, Manage Legal Cases, and Deliver Client Experiences

Platform Architecture: Telephony Gateway + Voice Agent Service + Clio Manage + Clio for Clients

Scope: Complete Business & Technical Workflow

Overview: The 4 Life Stages of a Modern Law Firm

To truly understand how this technology works, look at it as **4 sequential life stages**:

1. **Stage 1: Setting Up the Law Firm** — Configuring the firm's brand, staff roles, and phone number in Clio.
2. **Stage 2: Receiving the Phone Call** — A real caller dials the firm's number; the AI Voice Agent talks, questions, and records the intake.
3. **Stage 3: Managing the Case (The Lawyers' Work)** — The lawyer reviews the file in Clio Manage, schedules court appearances, and tracks billables.
4. **Stage 4: The Client Portal (The Client's Smartphone Experience)** — The client logs in on their phone to see case milestones, upload accident bills, and chat with their lawyer.

Stage 1: How to Set Up the Law Firm in Clio

When you open a law firm account in Clio Manage (<https://app.clio.com>), you perform four basic setup tasks:

- 1. Configure Firm Details:** Go to *Settings > Firm Profile*. Enter your firm name (e.g., *Apex Legal Group*), address, website, and upload your firm logo.
- 2. Set Up Practice Areas:** Go to *Settings > Practice Areas*. Add your core practice categories: *Personal Injury*, *Car Accidents*, *Contract Disputes*, *Family Law*.
- 3. Add Attorney & Staff User Accounts:** Go to *Settings > Manage Users*. Invite your attorneys (e.g., *Sarah Jenkins*, *Lead Counsel*) and paralegals with distinct access permissions.
- 4. Set Up the Firm's Dedicated Phone Number:** In your Voice Agent telephony console (or Twilio/Telnyx carrier), obtain a virtual phone number (e.g., **+1 (555) 234-5678**) and route it to your Voice Agent SIP endpoint.

Stage 2: How a Client Calls the Firm & How the Voice Agent Handles It

Here is the exact journey when an injured caller reaches your firm:

```
[ Caller: Mary Watson ] —(Dials Firm Phone: +1 555-234-5678)—> [ Carrier / Twilio SIP Trunk ]
                                                                |
                                                                v
[ AI Voice Agent Answers Sub-100ms ] <----- [ Voice Agent LiveKit Gateway ]
| 1. Greet: "Thank you for calling Apex Legal Group. How can I help you today?"
| 2. Mary: "I was injured in a collision with a commercial delivery van on 4th Street."
| 3. Agent: "I am sorry to hear that. What is your full name and phone number?"
| 4. Mary: "My name is Mary Watson, phone 555-019-3388."
| 5. Agent checks adverse party conflict: Queries Clio API for 'Delivery Van Corp' -> Clear!
                                                                |
                                                                v (Call Finishes)
[ Post-Call Processing Worker (agent/pipeline_worker.py) ]
| - Normalizes conversation audio into stereo WAV & saves to archive
| - Runs AI entity extraction (Name: Mary Watson, Phone: 555-019-3388, Type: Personal Injury)
| - Calls Clio API (agent/clio_connector.py) to push the file into Clio Manage!
```

Voice Agent Call Summary Output

Duration: 2m 14s | Status: Processed

Caller: Mary Watson | **Phone:** +1-555-019-3388 | **Email:** mary.watson@example.com
Case Category: Personal Injury (Vehicle Accident) | **Incident Date:** 2026-09-20
Opposing Party: Commercial Delivery Van | **Summary:** Caller was rear-ended at intersection; suffered neck sprain.

Stage 3: How the Law Firm Manages the Case in Clio Manage

Once the Voice Agent finishes the call, the attorney never has to do manual data entry. Everything appears in **Clio Manage**:

Clio Manage — Matter Overview: #00005-Watson (Mary Watson)		Status: Open Responsible Attorney: Sarah Jenkins	
Client:	Mary Watson (+1-555-019-3388)	Practice Area:	Personal Injury
Matter Description:	Vehicle collision on 4th St - Inbound Voice Intake	Originating Source:	AI Voice Agent Inbound Line
Trust Ledger Balance:	\$0.00 (Pending Initial Retainer)	Attached Audio:	call_recording_20260923_rec.wav

What the Firm Staff Does Inside Clio:

- Review the File:** The paralegal clicks into Matter [00005-Watson](#), reads the AI-generated executive summary, and listens to the recorded audio.
- Assign Onboarding Tasks:** With one click, the paralegal applies the firm's *"Personal Injury Task Template"*. Clio automatically assigns:
 - Task 1: Request Police Traffic Incident Report (Due in 3 days).
 - Task 2: Send Medical Authorization HIPPA Release to Mary (Due in 5 days).
- Court Calendaring:** The attorney enters the court hearing and statute of limitations deadline into Clio's rules-based calendar.
- Time Tracking & Billing:** The attorney starts Clio's built-in stopwatch timer whenever drafting court documents, logging billable hours automatically.

Stage 4: How the Client Portal Works for the Client ("Clio for Clients")

In traditional firms, clients call every week asking: "Did you get my police report? When is my court date?"

The Clio Client Portal eliminates this completely.

Step 1: The Firm Invites the Client

Inside Clio Manage, on Mary Watson's matter, the attorney clicks "**Share with Client Portal**". Clio automatically sends Mary an SMS and email with a secure link.

Step 2: What the Client Sees on Her Smartphone

Mary clicks the link and opens the **Clio for Clients** app on her smartphone:

Client Portal — Mary Watson's Smartphone View

Apex Legal Group

Your Case: Motor Vehicle Collision (#00005-Watson)

Your Lead Attorney: Sarah Jenkins, Esq. (sarah@apexlegal.com)

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Upcoming Milestones:

- October 14, 2026: Preliminary Status Conference (Attorney Attending)

Documents & Uploads:

- [Download] Signed Retainer Agreement.pdf
- [Upload Button] "Tap here to take a photo of your medical bills or auto repair estimates"

Direct Lawyer Messaging:

"Hi Mary, we received your police report today. Our team is preparing the demand letter."

Step 3: Why Clients Love the Client Portal

- Instant Document Uploads:** When Mary gets a doctor's bill, she takes a photo with her phone and taps upload. The photo saves directly into Clio Manage under her matter's document folder.
- Secure Messaging:** No lost emails or spam folders. Messages are encrypted and stored right inside the case file for attorney-client privilege.
- Online Payments:** Mary can pay court filing fees or retainers using Apple Pay, Google Pay, or debit card directly through the portal via Clio Payments.

5. Summary Architecture Diagram

